KCE PATHWAYS · GRADE 3 · UNIT 4: PARTS AND PIECES · WEEK 16 · READING

Clues in the Sugarhouse — Teacher Lesson Plan & Answer Key

Learning objectives: Students use context clues to figure out unknown words: definition clues (signal words is, means, called), synonym clues (or, also, like), and antonym clues (but, unlike, not). They choose the meaning of a multiple-meaning word that fits the sentence, and review Unit 3 text features (heading, caption, glossary).

Duration: 35–45 minutes
Materials: Computer or tablet with the lesson open · pencil · printed Pre & Post sheet

Lesson flow (as it appears on screen)

1. Title and name: the student types first and last name so results go to KingCretot Experience. Read the Pathway Points rules together: 2 tries per question, points only for a correct first try, and the answer and reason appear after a second miss. Introduce sugaring season at Aunt June's maple farm in Vermont with Hazel and Desmond.
2. Warm-Up, Part 1: Unit 3 Review (6 pts, 3 each): text features on a "Maple Trees All Year" book page (a different season in each set). Have the student point to the heading, caption and glossary first.
3. Warm-Up, Part 2 (6 pts, 3 each): find-the-mistake and typed text-feature items with the same book page.
4. Pencil Break (Pre): the student opens or prints the Pre/Post sheet (grade3/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G3W16.pdf) and completes Page 1 (Pre) before any teaching. Do not help with answers; it shows what they already know.
5. Word Wrangler: 6 vocabulary cards (context clues, synonym, antonym, multiple-meaning word, sap, sugarhouse). Have the student say each word and meaning back.
6. Picture It: Be a Word Detective. Read the whole sentence and the sentences around a new word. Ask: what signal words point to a clue?
7. Read: "The First Sap Run." Have the student read at least one part aloud and point out any bold or tricky words before the teaching slides.
8. Definition Clues: The Text Tells You (8 pts): one typed and one multiple-choice item from the story. Tip: circle is, means, called, or which is.
9. Synonym Clues: Same Meaning Nearby (8 pts): pail/bucket, sturdy/strong, fragrant/sweet. Tip: if "or" is followed by one word with the same meaning, it is a synonym clue.
10. Antonym Clues: Opposite Meaning Nearby (8 pts): but, unlike and not. Tip: find the opposite word, then flip it.
11. Multiple-Meaning Words (8 pts): light, bark, run, tap. Tip: try each meaning in the sentence and ask which one makes sense.
12. Word Work Bonus: The Prefix un- (XP only, not scored).
13. Match-Up Round (10 pts, 2 per first-try match): Set 1 matches clue types to meanings, Set 2 matches story words to meanings, Set 3 matches multiple-meaning sentences to the meaning that fits.
14. Fix the Sentence (10 pts, 5 each): each item names the one kind of fix (capital letters, end mark, list commas, or one verb). The whole sentence is checked exactly; curly quotes and extra spaces are forgiven. The corrected sentence appears after the 2nd miss.

15. ⌨ Type-It Corral, Part 1 (8 pts, 4 each): typed vocabulary and text-detail answers; capital letters and a final period do not matter, but spelling does. The “Look back” panel is allowed.
16. ⌨ Type-It Corral, Part 2 (8 pts): more typed answers, same checking rules.
17. Speed Arena and Keyboard Corral (XP only, not scored).
18. Boss Battle, Part 1: Sugarhouse Challenge (10 pts, 5 each): two-step clue-type-plus-meaning items and a typed meaning from the story.
19. Boss Battle, Part 2: Final Round (10 pts, 5 each): find-the-mistake on sorted clues and a typed antonym-clue item.
20. Pencil Break (Post): the student turns to Page 2 (Post) of the same sheet (grade3/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G3W16.pdf) and completes it, plus the ★ Challenge if time allows, before seeing the score. The sheet buttons let the student open or print it again.
21. Results (Sugarhouse Day Complete!): the score out of 100 is sent to KingCretot Experience. 85 or higher shows “Context Clue Master!” with the congratulations message “Context clue master!” and a big confetti burst; below 85 shows “Great Effort Today!” with encouragement (“It takes about forty gallons of sap to make one gallon of syrup. Great things take time, and so do new skills!”), and the next attempt brings a fresh question set (sets rotate 1, 2, 3). Both messages remind the student to finish the Post-Lesson Challenge sheet.

Lesson answer key with reasoning

Every scored item the student sees, in order, across all three rotating question sets. Each item allows 2 tries and earns Pathway Points only on a correct first try. The "why" is the same reasoning shown on screen after a second missed try.

WARM-UP: UNIT 3 REVIEW (3 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
w1_s0	Set 1: *Book page Maple Trees All Year Winter: Time to Rest In winter, a maple tree has no leaves. The tree is dormant. It saves its energy until spring. Under the snow, its roots stay alive. A bare sugar maple on a snowy hill in January. Glossary dormant: resting and not growing for a while roots: the parts of a plant that grow under the ground Read the page* Which text feature tells you what the bold word dormant means? [The glossary / The caption / The heading / The book title]	**The glossary**	A glossary lists important words in ABC order and tells what each one means. The bold word dormant is in the glossary.
w2_s0	Set 1: Use the glossary. A dormant tree is resting and not ___ for a while.	**growing** (also accepted: grow)	The glossary says dormant means resting and not growing for a while.
w3_s0	Set 1: Find the mistake! Desmond says the heading tells what the picture shows. What went wrong? [The caption tells what the picture shows. The heading, Winter: Time to Rest, tells what the section is about. / The heading is the same thing as the bold word. / Pictures in a book never have words with them. / Nothing went wrong.]	**The caption tells what the picture shows. The heading, Winter: Time to Rest, tells what the section is about.**	The caption is the sentence under the picture, and it tells what the picture shows. The heading names what the section is about.
w4_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: The words under a picture that tell about it are called a ___.	**caption** (also accepted: a caption, captions)	A caption is the words under a picture that tell about it.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
w1_s1	Set 2: *Book page Maple Trees All Year Spring: The Sap Flows In early spring, sap moves up from the roots to the branches. Farmers put a spout in each tree to collect it. Most farmers collect sap for about six weeks. Sap drips from a spout into a bucket in March. Glossary sap: the watery liquid inside a tree spout: a small tube that liquid flows out of Read the page* Two steps! Find the bold word on the page. Then use the glossary. Which choice names the bold word AND its meaning? [spout: a small tube that liquid flows out of / sap: the watery liquid inside a tree / spout: a bucket that holds sap / roots: the parts that grow under the ground]	**spout: a small tube that liquid flows out of**	The bold word is spout. The glossary says a spout is a small tube that liquid flows out of. Sap is in the glossary too, but it is not the bold word.
w2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: The caption says sap drips from a spout into a ___.	**bucket** (also accepted: a bucket)	The caption says: Sap drips from a spout into a bucket in March.
w3_s1	Set 2: Which explanation is correct? Hazel says the glossary is in ABC order so you can find a word fast. Desmond says the glossary lists words in the order they appear in the text. [Hazel is right, because a glossary lists words in ABC order / Desmond is right, because words are listed in the order you read them / Both are right / Neither is right, because a glossary has no order]	**Hazel is right, because a glossary lists words in ABC order**	A glossary is in ABC order, so sap comes before spout. ABC order helps you find a word fast.
w4_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: The heading tells you this section is about the season of ___.	**spring** (also accepted: early spring)	The heading is Spring: The Sap Flows.
w1_s2	Set 3: *Book page Maple Trees All Year Fall: Leaves of Many Colors In fall, maple leaves turn red, orange, and yellow. Then the leaves drop to the ground. This is why maples are called deciduous trees. A red maple leaf in October. Glossary deciduous: losing all its leaves every fall season: one of the four parts of the year Read the page* Which text feature tells you this section is mostly about maple trees in fall? [The heading / The glossary / The caption / The bold word]	**The heading**	The heading, Fall: Leaves of Many Colors, tells what the section is mostly about.
w2_s2	Set 3: Use the glossary. A deciduous tree loses all its ___ every fall.	**leaves** (also accepted: its leaves)	The glossary says deciduous means losing all its leaves every fall.
w3_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Hazel says the caption tells what the word deciduous means. What went wrong? [The glossary tells what deciduous means. The caption tells about the picture of the leaf. / The caption is the title of the book. / Deciduous is not a bold word. / Nothing went wrong.]	**The glossary tells what deciduous means. The caption tells about the picture of the leaf.**	The glossary tells what deciduous means. The caption only tells about the picture of the leaf.
w4_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: A list of important words and their meanings at the back of a book is called a ___.	**glossary** (also accepted: a glossary)	A glossary is a list of important words and their meanings, usually at the back of a book.

DEFINITION CLUES: THE TEXT TELLS YOU (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
t1a_s0	Set 1: Part 2 says, “Then she handed Desmond a metal spout called a tap.” Use the definition clue. A tap is a metal ___.	**spout** (also accepted: metal spout, a metal spout, a spout)	The signal word called tells you the meaning: a tap is a metal spout.
t1b_s0	Set 1: Two steps! Find the definition clue for evaporator in Part 4. Then choose what it means. [Clue: a long, flat pan called an evaporator. Meaning: a pan where sap boils / Clue: The steam was fragrant. Meaning: a sweet smell / Clue: a long, flat pan called an evaporator. Meaning: a building where syrup is sold / Clue: poured hot syrup onto clean snow. Meaning: a kind of candy]	**Clue: a long, flat pan called an evaporator. Meaning: a pan where sap boils**	Part 4 says the sap boiled in a long, flat pan called an evaporator. The signal word called points to the meaning.
t1a_s1	Set 2: Part 1 says, “Sap is the thin, clear liquid that flows inside a maple tree.” Which signal word tells you a definition is coming? The signal word right after sap is ___.	**is**	In “Sap is the thin, clear liquid...,” the signal word is comes right after sap, and then the meaning follows.
t1b_s1	Set 2: Which explanation is correct? Hazel says brisk means cold and fresh, because the words right after it explain it. Desmond says brisk means muddy, because the story says they rode up a muddy hill. [Hazel is right, because “so cold and fresh that it made their cheeks sting” explains brisk / Desmond is right, because muddy is the closest describing word / Desmond is right, because brisk air is always muddy / Neither is right, because there is no clue for brisk]	**Hazel is right, because “so cold and fresh that it made their cheeks sting” explains brisk**	The words right after brisk, so cold and fresh that it made their cheeks sting, explain what brisk air feels like. Muddy describes the hill, not the air.
t1a_s2	Set 3: Part 4 says, “As the water evaporated, or turned into steam and floated away, the sap got thicker.” When water evaporates, it turns into ___.	**steam**	The words after or, turned into steam and floated away, define evaporated.
t1b_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Desmond read, “Aunt June checked the thermometer, a tool that measures how hot or cold something is.” He said a thermometer is a hot drink. What went wrong? [He skipped the definition clue. The words right after thermometer say it is a tool that measures how hot or cold something is. / A thermometer really is a hot drink. / There is no clue in the sentence. / Nothing went wrong.]	**He skipped the definition clue. The words right after thermometer say it is a tool that measures how hot or cold something is.**	The words right after thermometer tell what it is: a tool that measures how hot or cold something is. Desmond skipped the definition clue.

SYNONYM CLUES: SAME MEANING NEARBY (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
t2a_s0	Set 1: Part 2 says, “Hazel hung a pail, or bucket, on a hook under the tap.” The synonym clue for pail is ___.	**bucket** (also accepted: a bucket)	The signal word or is followed by one word, bucket, which means the same as pail.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
t2b_s0	Set 1: Which sentence uses a SYNONYM clue to explain the word in bold? [The path was slick, or slippery, after the rain. / The path was slick, but the road was dry and rough. / A maple is a tree that makes sweet sap. / Desmond tapped the spout into the hole.]	**The path was slick, or slippery, after the rain.**	Slippery means the same as slick, and the signal word or points to it. The other sentences use an antonym clue, a definition clue, or no clue.
t2a_s1	Set 2: Part 3 says, "Aunt June's sled was sturdy. It was strong enough to carry six full pails without wobbling or breaking." The word that means almost the same as sturdy is ___.	**strong**	The next sentence says the sled was strong enough to carry six full pails. Strong means almost the same as sturdy.
t2b_s1	Set 2: Which explanation is correct? Hazel says "a pail, or bucket" is a synonym clue, because or is followed by one word that means the same. Desmond says "evaporated, or turned into steam and floated away" is a synonym clue too. [Hazel is right. Desmond's example is a definition clue, because or is followed by a whole explanation. / Desmond is right, because every or makes a synonym clue / Both are wrong, because or is never a signal word / Hazel is wrong, because bucket and pail mean opposite things]	**Hazel is right. Desmond's example is a definition clue, because or is followed by a whole explanation.**	When or is followed by one word with the same meaning, it is a synonym clue. When or is followed by a whole explanation, it is a definition clue.
t2a_s2	Set 3: Part 4 says, "The steam was fragrant. It smelled sweet, like warm cookies." Fragrant means smelling ___.	**sweet** (also accepted: good, nice)	The next sentence explains fragrant: it smelled sweet, like warm cookies.
t2b_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Desmond read, "The sap moved slowly, or sluggishly, through the tube." He said sluggishly means quickly. What went wrong? [The synonym clue slowly comes right before or, so sluggishly means slowly, not quickly. / Sluggishly is an antonym clue, so it means the opposite of slowly. / There is no clue in the sentence. / Nothing went wrong.]	**The synonym clue slowly comes right before or, so sluggishly means slowly, not quickly.**	Slowly comes right before or, so it is the synonym clue. Sluggishly means slowly, not quickly.

ANTONYM CLUES: OPPOSITE MEANING NEARBY (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
t3a_s0	Set 1: Part 5 says, "Boiling sap is tedious. Unlike quick, exciting jobs, it takes hours of watching, waiting, and adding more sap." Which signal word tells you an antonym clue is coming? The signal word is ___.	**unlike**	Unlike is a signal word for an antonym clue. It tells you tedious is the opposite of quick and exciting.
t3b_s0	Set 1: Which explanation is correct? Hazel says tedious means slow and boring, because unlike tells her it is the opposite of quick and exciting. Desmond says tedious means quick and exciting, because those words are right next to it. [Hazel is right, because unlike signals an opposite / Desmond is right, because words next to each other always mean the same thing / Desmond is right, because boiling sap is fast / Neither is right, because tedious means sweet and sticky]	**Hazel is right, because unlike signals an opposite**	Unlike signals an opposite. Tedious is the opposite of quick and exciting, so it means slow and boring.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
t3a_s1	Set 2: Two steps! Read: “The sugarhouse window was clear, but the thick steam made it opaque.” Step 1: Find the clue. Step 2: Choose what opaque means. [Clue: clear (antonym). Opaque means you cannot see through it. / Clue: clear (antonym). Opaque means easy to see through. / Clue: steam (synonym). Opaque means hot and wet. / Clue: window (definition). Opaque means a kind of glass.]	**Clue: clear (antonym). Opaque means you cannot see through it.**	But signals an opposite. Opaque is the opposite of clear, so an opaque window is one you cannot see through.
t3b_s1	Set 2: Read: “Hazel was patient and waited calmly, but Desmond was restless and kept jumping up to check the pan.” Restless is the opposite of ___.	**patient** (also accepted: calm, calmly)	But signals an opposite. Restless is the opposite of patient, which means waiting calmly.
t3a_s2	Set 3: Read: “The first pail was empty, but the second pail was brimming with sap.” Brimming is the opposite of ___.	**empty**	But signals an opposite. Brimming is the opposite of empty, so it means full to the top.
t3b_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Hazel read, “Instead of rushing, Aunt June walked at a leisurely pace.” She said leisurely means fast. What went wrong? [Instead of signals an opposite. Leisurely is the opposite of rushing, so it means slow and relaxed. / Instead of signals a synonym, so leisurely means rushing. / Leisurely is a definition clue for the word pace. / Nothing went wrong.]	**Instead of signals an opposite. Leisurely is the opposite of rushing, so it means slow and relaxed.**	Instead of signals an opposite. Leisurely is the opposite of rushing, so it means slow and relaxed.

MULTIPLE-MEANING WORDS (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
t4a_s0	Set 1: Part 2 says, “Aunt June drilled a small hole in the trunk of a tall maple.” What does trunk mean in this sentence? [the main stem of a tree / an elephant’s long nose / a storage space in the back of a car / a big box for clothes]	**the main stem of a tree**	Aunt June is drilling into a tall maple, so trunk means the main stem of the tree.
t4b_s0	Set 1: Part 4 says, “The first syrup of the season was light, a pale gold color like honey.” Here, light tells about color. The word from the sentence that means almost the same as light here is ___.	**pale**	The sentence says the syrup was light, a pale gold color. Here, light means pale, not “not heavy.”
t4a_s1	Set 2: Which explanation is correct? Hazel says tap means the same thing in “She handed Desmond a metal spout called a tap” and “He gently tapped it into the hole.” Desmond says the first tap is a thing, a spout, and tapped means hit something lightly. [Desmond is right, because tap is a multiple-meaning word / Hazel is right, because words spelled the same always mean the same thing / Hazel is right, because both sentences are about a hammer / Neither is right, because tap only means a water faucet]	**Desmond is right, because tap is a multiple-meaning word**	In the first sentence, tap is a thing: a metal spout. In the second, tapped means hit something lightly. Tap is a multiple-meaning word.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
t4b_s1	Set 2: Read both sentences: “The dog will ___ at the squirrel.” and “The rough ___ scratched his mittens.” The one word that fits both is ___.	**bark**	Bark is a multiple-meaning word: a dog can bark, and a tree has rough bark.
t4a_s2	Set 3: Read both sentences: “Sap began to ___ into the pail.” and “Desmond likes to ___ races with Hazel.” The one word that fits both is ___.	**run**	Run is a multiple-meaning word: sap can run, or flow, and people can run races.
t4b_s2	Set 3: Which explanation is correct? Desmond says trunk means the main stem of a tree in “Aunt June put the empty pails in the trunk of her car.” Hazel says it means the storage space in a car, because the words of her car are a clue. [Hazel is right, because the words of her car show which meaning fits / Desmond is right, because trunk always means part of a tree / Desmond is right, because the pails came from the trees / Neither is right, because trunk means an elephant’s nose]	**Hazel is right, because the words of her car show which meaning fits**	The words of her car are the clue. Here trunk means the storage space in a car, not part of a tree.

MATCH-UP ROUND (2 POINTS PER FIRST-TRY MATCH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
match_s0_1	Set 1: Match Context clues	**words around a new word that help show its meaning**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_2	Set 1: Match Synonym	**a word that means the same**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_3	Set 1: Match Antonym	**a word that means the opposite**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_4	Set 1: Match Multiple-meaning word	**one word with more than one meaning**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_5	Set 1: Match Definition clue	**the text tells you what the word means**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_1	Set 2: Match brisk	**cold and fresh**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_2	Set 2: Match pail	**bucket**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_3	Set 2: Match drowsy	**sleepy**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_4	Set 2: Match sturdy	**strong and hard to break**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_5	Set 2: Match fragrant	**sweet-smelling**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_1	Set 3: Match “Soon the sap began to run.”	**flow like a liquid**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_2	Set 3: Match “Run to the barn!”	**move fast on your feet**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_3	Set 3: Match “The rough bark scratched his mittens.”	**the covering of a tree**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_4	Set 3: Match “The dogs bark at night.”	**make a short, loud sound**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_5	Set 3: Match “Push the tap into the hole.”	**a metal spout for sap**	2 points if matched on the first try.

FIX THE SENTENCE (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
fx1_s0	Set 1: Fix the sentence. Two words need capital letters: the first word and the name of a state. hazel visited Aunt June in vermont.	**Hazel visited Aunt June in Vermont.**	Every sentence starts with a capital letter, and the name of a state, Vermont, always gets a capital letter too.
fx2_s0	Set 1: Fix the sentence. This asking sentence needs an end mark. Is the sap ready yet	**Is the sap ready yet?**	An asking sentence ends with a question mark.
fx1_s1	Set 2: Fix the sentence. Add commas to separate the things in the list. We need pails taps and a hammer.	**We need pails, taps, and a hammer.** (also accepted: We need pails, taps and a hammer.)	Use commas to separate three or more things in a list: pails, taps, and a hammer.
fx2_s1	Set 2: Fix the sentence. One verb is wrong. Desmond is one person. Desmond were drowsy in the warm sugarhouse.	**Desmond was drowsy in the warm sugarhouse.**	Desmond is one person, so the verb is was, not were.
fx1_s2	Set 3: Fix the sentence. A name needs capital letters, and so does the first word. aunt june poured syrup on the snow.	**Aunt June poured syrup on the snow.**	A name and a title like Aunt June always get capital letters. Aunt is also the first word of the sentence.
fx2_s2	Set 3: Fix the sentence. One verb does not match. The sap is one thing. The sap drip into the pail.	**The sap drips into the pail.** (also accepted: The sap dripped into the pail.)	The sap is one thing, so the verb needs an s: The sap drips into the pail.

⌨ TYPE-IT CORRAL (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
ty1_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: Words and sentences around a new word that help you figure out its meaning are called context ___.	**clues** (also accepted: clue)	Context clues are the words and sentences around a new word that help you figure out what it means.
ty2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: Aunt June says it takes about forty gallons of sap to make one gallon of ___.	**syrup** (also accepted: maple syrup)	Part 3: It takes about forty gallons of sap to make just one gallon of syrup.
ty3_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: A word that means the opposite of another word is an ___.	**antonym** (also accepted: an antonym, antonyms)	An antonym is a word that means the opposite of another word.
ty4_s0	Set 1: Read: “The trail was narrow, not wide enough for two sleds.” Narrow means not ___.	**wide**	The signal word not points to the opposite: wide. Narrow means not wide.
ty1_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: A word that means the same or almost the same as another word is a ___.	**synonym** (also accepted: a synonym, synonyms)	A synonym is a word that means the same or almost the same as another word.
ty2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: When Aunt June poured hot syrup onto clean snow, it hardened into chewy maple ___.	**candy** (also accepted: maple candy)	Part 5: It hardened into chewy maple candy.
ty3_s1	Set 2: Read: “The bucket of sap was heavy, so Hazel needed help to lift it. The basket of mittens was light.” Here, light means not ___.	**heavy**	The bucket was heavy, and the basket was the opposite. Here, light means not heavy.
ty4_s1	Set 2: Read: “Desmond was famished, or very hungry, after a long day in the cold.” Famished means very ___.	**hungry**	The words after or, very hungry, tell what famished means.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
ty1_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: A word like bark, which has more than one meaning, is called a multiple-meaning ___.	**word** (also accepted: words)	A word like bark has more than one meaning, so it is a multiple-meaning word.
ty2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: Aunt June says sap runs when nights are cold and days are ___.	**warm**	Part 1: Cold nights and warm days make the sap run.
ty3_s2	Set 3: Read: "Hazel was timid at first, but by the end of the day she was brave enough to drill a hole herself." Timid is the opposite of ___.	**brave**	But signals an opposite. Timid is the opposite of brave, so timid means shy or easily scared.
ty4_s2	Set 3: Read: "The cousins were jubilant, or very happy, when they tasted the candy." Jubilant means very ___.	**happy** (also accepted: joyful, glad)	The words after or, very happy, tell what jubilant means.

BOSS BATTLE: SUGARHOUSE CHALLENGE (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
bb1_s0	Set 1: Two steps! Which kind of clue explains sturdy in Part 3, and what does sturdy mean? [A synonym clue (strong). Sturdy means strong and hard to break. / An antonym clue (strong). Sturdy means weak. / A definition clue (wobbling). Sturdy means shaky. / A multiple-meaning word. Sturdy means a kind of sled.]	**A synonym clue (strong). Sturdy means strong and hard to break.**	The next sentence says the sled was strong enough to carry six full pails. Strong means almost the same as sturdy, so it is a synonym clue.
bb2_s0	Set 1: Part 5 says, "Desmond grew drowsy in the warm sugarhouse, but Hazel stayed alert." Later, Desmond is wide awake. So drowsy means ___.	**sleepy** (also accepted: tired)	But signals an opposite. Drowsy is the opposite of alert, and later Desmond is wide awake. So drowsy means sleepy.
bb1_s1	Set 2: Which explanation is correct? Hazel says light in "The first syrup of the season was light" means not heavy. Desmond says it means pale, because the sentence goes on to say "a pale gold color like honey." [Desmond is right, because the rest of the sentence is about color / Hazel is right, because light always means not heavy / Hazel is right, because syrup is easy to carry / Neither is right, because light means a lamp]	**Desmond is right, because the rest of the sentence is about color**	The words right after light, a pale gold color like honey, show that light means pale in color here, not "not heavy."
bb2_s1	Set 2: Part 4 says the water evaporated, or turned into steam and floated away. With less water, the sap got ___ and sweeter.	**thicker** (also accepted: thick)	When the water evaporated, it floated away as steam. With less water, the sap got thicker and sweeter.
bb1_s2	Set 3: Two steps! Read: "The empty pail was light, but the full pail was heavy." Step 1: Find the clue. Step 2: Choose what light means here. [Clue: heavy (antonym). Light means not heavy. / Clue: heavy (antonym). Light means pale in color. / Clue: pail (synonym). Light means a lamp. / Clue: full (definition). Light means bright.]	**Clue: heavy (antonym). Light means not heavy.**	But signals an opposite: heavy. Flip it, and light means not heavy in this sentence.
bb2_s2	Set 3: Part 1 says, "The air was brisk, so cold and fresh that it made their cheeks sting." Brisk air feels cold and ___.	**fresh**	Part 1 explains brisk: so cold and fresh that it made their cheeks sting.

BOSS BATTLE: FINAL ROUND (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
bb3_s0	Set 1: Find the mistake! Desmond sorted three clues. “a pail, or bucket” = synonym clue. “tedious... Unlike quick, exciting jobs” = antonym clue. “a metal spout called a tap” = antonym clue. Which one did he get wrong? [“a metal spout called a tap.” It is a definition clue, because called tells the meaning. / “a pail, or bucket.” It is an antonym clue. / “tedious... Unlike quick, exciting jobs.” It is a synonym clue. / He got them all right.]	**“a metal spout called a tap.” It is a definition clue, because called tells the meaning.**	Called is a signal word for a definition clue. It tells you that a tap is a metal spout.
bb4_s0	Set 1: Read: “The snow in the woods was powdery and soft, unlike the hard, icy crust on the path.” Powdery snow is soft, not hard and ___.	**icy**	Unlike signals an opposite. Powdery snow is soft, unlike the hard, icy crust.
bb3_s1	Set 2: Find the mistake! Desmond read, “The path near the sugarhouse was slushy, but the path in the woods was frozen solid.” He said slushy means frozen solid. What went wrong? [But signals an opposite. Slushy is the opposite of frozen solid, so it means soft, wet, and partly melted. / But signals a synonym, so slushy means frozen solid. / Slushy is a definition clue for the word woods. / Nothing went wrong.]	**But signals an opposite. Slushy is the opposite of frozen solid, so it means soft, wet, and partly melted.**	But signals an opposite. Slushy is the opposite of frozen solid, so it means soft, wet, and partly melted.
bb4_s1	Set 2: Read both sentences: “Turn on the ___ to fill the sink with water.” and “Push the metal ___ into the maple tree.” The one word that fits both is ___.	**tap**	Tap is a multiple-meaning word: a faucet you turn on, or a metal spout for sap.
bb3_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Hazel read, “The baby birds were tiny, but the mother bird looked enormous next to them.” She said enormous means very small. What went wrong? [But signals an opposite. Enormous is the opposite of tiny, so it means very big. / But signals a synonym, so enormous means tiny. / Enormous is a multiple-meaning word that means a bird. / Nothing went wrong.]	**But signals an opposite. Enormous is the opposite of tiny, so it means very big.**	But signals an opposite. Enormous is the opposite of tiny, so it means very big.
bb4_s2	Set 3: Read: “Aunt June’s maple trees are ancient. Some of them are more than 150 years old!” Ancient means very ___.	**old**	The next sentence gives the clue: some trees are more than 150 years old. Ancient means very old.

Pre & Post sheet answer guide

Many items are open-ended. Grade for genuine understanding and complete sentences, not exact wording. Sheet: grade3/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G3W16.pdf.

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Which feature tells what a bold word means?	the glossary

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
2	What is a parka?	A long warm coat with a hood (the definition is right after the comma).
3	Word that means the same as chilly	cold (the “or” clue)
4	What does vacant mean? Which word helped?	empty. The word but and the opposite word full show vacant means the opposite of full.
5	Meaning of ring in “Aunt June wore a silver ring”	a circle you wear on your finger. You wear it, and it is silver, so it is not a sound.

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Hazel was cautious, or careful	Clue: “or careful” (synonym clue). Cautious means careful.
2	Desmond was grumpy, unlike Hazel, who was cheerful	Clue: “unlike Hazel, who was cheerful” (antonym clue). Grumpy means in a bad mood, the opposite of cheerful.
3	Desmond says light in “light the fire” means pale	Here light means to start the fire burning. Pale is a different meaning of light that does not fit this sentence.
4	Fix: hazel desmond and aunt june boiled sap in vermont	Hazel, Desmond, and Aunt June boiled sap in Vermont. (Also accept without the comma before and.)

★ CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Sentence with a context clue for gigantic	Answers vary. Example: The pumpkin was gigantic, or very big. (synonym clue) Check that the clue really shows the meaning and is named correctly.